

Feb. 23: Waris Punjab De chief and radical **Amritpal Singh Sandhu** lays siege to police station in Ajnala to free aide. Clashes ensue, aide freed the next day



Feb. 26: Two Jaggu Bhagwanpuria gang members accused in the Moosewala murder case **killed in Tarn Taran jail by inmates belonging to Lawrence Bishnoi gang**

THE PANTHIC CHURN



Pro-Khalistan Shiromani Akali Dal (Amritsar) leader **Simranjit Mann wins Lok Sabha byelection** from Sangrur in June 2022, defeating AAP candidate

Marches taken out the same month with police protection in Amritsar on the **anniversary of Operation Blue Star** to commemorate the 1984 'martyrs'

Protests to seek **release of 22 convicted Sikh terrorists** continue. In early February 2023, 30 policemen injured when hundreds of well-armed protesters clash with police while trying to storm CM Mann's residence. Their demand: release of 'bandi' Sikh prisoners across India

Radical speeches from the Akal Takht, with the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) trying to recover lost religious and political ground

Protests continue against the **deaths of two people in police firing** in Behbal Kalan in 2015 during an agitation against alleged sacrilege involving Guru Granth Sahib

LOSING THE PLOT

In April last year, gets flak for **selecting outsiders and businessmen as Rajya Sabha MPs** from the state

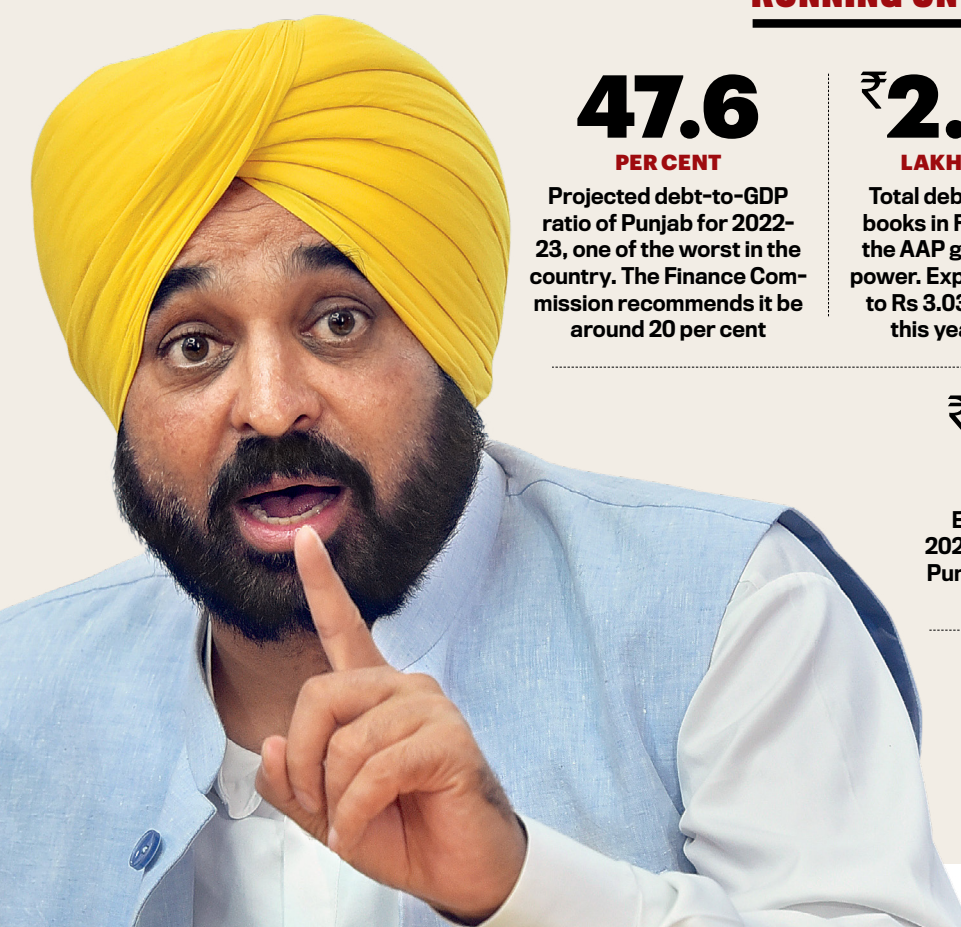
In September, after a trip to Germany, **claims that BMW is setting up a unit** in Punjab. The German motor company denies it later

In mid-December, claims that **gangster Goldy Brar had been arrested** in the US and would be extradited to India soon; Brar refutes it himself on news channels

In Feb. 2023, offers to **buy onions from distressed Gujarat farmers**. Punjab farm unions criticise the move

Allegations surface that AAP is **using resources** from Punjab to campaign in Gujarat, Himachal, Telangana and Delhi

RUNNING ON RESERVE



47.6
PER CENT
Projected debt-to-GDP ratio of Punjab for 2022-23, one of the worst in the country. The Finance Commission recommends it be around 20 per cent

₹2.83
LAKH CRORE
Total debt on state's books in FY22 before the AAP govt came to power. Expected to rise to Rs 3.03 lakh crore this year (FY23)

₹500
CRORE
Loans taken by state power corporation PSPCL to pay salaries, other dues till January; its daily subsidies amount to Rs 54 crore

₹95,378
CRORE
Estimated revenue receipts for 2022-23. For the past several years, Punjab has fallen short by around 14 per cent every year

₹35,946
CRORE
Estimated debt repayment for FY23

Source: Punjab budget papers